

100 Days of Linux - Day 020

Title: Module 2 Practical Workflow - File Viewing & Editing

Today's Goal

Complete a realistic workflow using all file viewing and editing commands learned so far. No new commands are introduced today.

Why This Matters

In real jobs you'll create, edit, inspect, and verify files many times a day. Today's assignment combines these skills into one workflow.

Commands Covered

nano, cat, head, tail, less, more, pwd, ls, cd, mkdir, touch, cp, mv

Workflow Instructions

Complete each task in order and verify your work after every step.

Practical Assignment (5 Tasks)

1. Create a directory named `module2_project`. Inside it create files `README.md`, `notes.txt`, and `employees.txt`. Open each file with Nano and add meaningful content.
2. Display the entire `README.md` file using `cat`. Display the first 5 lines and last 5 lines of `employees.txt`.
3. Open `employees.txt` using `less`, search for a word, quit, then open the same file using `more` and browse one page.
4. Copy `README.md` to `README_backup.md`. Rename `notes.txt` to `linux_notes.txt` and verify all files using `ls`.
5. Display your command history, print your current working directory, and clear the terminal.

Hints

Save every Nano file before exiting. Use `ls` after copying or renaming files to verify the results.

Mini Challenge

Create a folder named `documentation`. Inside it create `project.txt`, `commands.txt`, and `summary.txt`. Fill them with content using Nano, inspect them with `cat/head/tail`, then create a backup copy of `commands.txt`.

Common Mistakes

Skipping verification after editing a file. Always reopen or display the file to ensure your changes were saved.

Did You Know?

Reading and editing configuration files from the terminal is a core Linux skill used by developers, system administrators, and data engineers.

Pro Tip

When working with large files, combine Nano for editing and less for browsing instead of printing everything with cat.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Task1: `mkdir module2_project && cd module2_project && touch README.md notes.txt employees.txt && nano each file`

Task2: `cat README.md && head -n 5 employees.txt && tail -n 5 employees.txt`

Task3: `less employees.txt (/, q)` then more `employees.txt (Space, q)`

Task4: `cp README.md README_backup.md && mv notes.txt linux_notes.txt && ls`

Task5: `history && pwd && clear`

Homework

Repeat today's workflow without looking at the answer key. Aim to complete it smoothly and confidently.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll begin Module 3 by learning the `find` command to locate files and directories anywhere in the Linux filesystem.